

Mendip Caving Group

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Dear Mr Waddington

16 January
1988

I am writing to enquire if you would be able to make available a copy of your Cave Survey Programme for the BBC Micro, as described in the recent NPC Journal.

Should you be able to make a copy available please inform me of the number of blank discs required and I will send them to you, together with the cost of return postage.

Yours sincerely



Alan Dougherty

Tackle Officer MCG

Mendip Caving Group

Headquarters : Nordrach Cottage, Charterhouse-on-Mendip, Blagdon, Bristol BS18 6XW

Wynhayes
Station Road
Wroughton
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18 March 1988

Dear Andy

Many thanks for your offer to supply 'SUBBC'. Please find enclosed two formatted discs and £5.00 cheque.

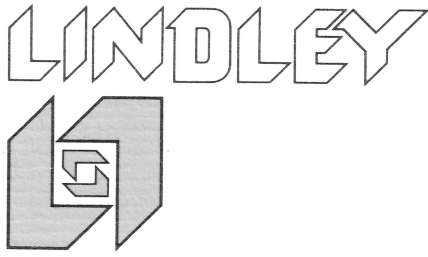
I intend to use the program on the micro at the school where I work. This is a BBC Acorn, Model B. 32K. I hope this is adequate to cope with the program.

It is likely that the LEA will supply updated versions of the BBC micro in the near future.

Yours sincerely



Alan Dougherty



Lindley Educational Trust Ltd.,
Swinton Castle,
Masham,
North Yorkshire,
HG4 4JH
Tel: Ripon (0765) 89254

Dear Andy,

Some time ago I saw you demonstrating the Survey Programme SUBBC at a conference. I was impressed then but had no computer to play with.

I've just read your article on use of computers in caving in the N.P.C. Journal 1987 and see that the programme is still available from you.

I've just taken delivery of an Archimedes (show off arn't I ?) and now can investigate more how to use this in my caving, both for personal use and for work which has a high caving content (lucky eh ?).

I would be grateful (creep creep) if you would answer some questions about SUBBC for me.

Can you supply the programme on 3.5" ADFS disks ?

Is the programme in Machine Code ? If so does it write directly to the screen ?

How much is it ?

I would also be interested in any further information that you have on the use of computers in caving.

Ta Muchly!

Steve Laugher

Providing a Nationwide Training Service.

Pennine Software

Steve Laugher,
Lindley Educational Trust,
Swinton Castle,
Masham,
N.Yorkshire,
HG4 4JH

Dear Steve,

Thanks for your letter about SUBBC. Sorry for the excessive delay in replying - I have not visited Greenclose very much this year, as I have been busy doing wintery sports in France and Scotland, so I only got your letter quite recently.

I answer your questions:

Yes, the program is still available.

Yes, I can supply it on any kind of media that BBC's can cope with. In your case this means 3.5" ADFS (640k, not 800k) floppy disc.

No it doesn't contain machine code. The version of the program that you would have seen at a BCRA conference did indeed contain quite a lot of machine code, to optimise string searching. However, BASIC for the ARM is so much faster that I now have a version which does all the string searches in BASIC. This is horrendously much slower on a BBC, but faster than the original version when running on an ARM second processor (original BBC version took 25 minutes to process 1200 stations, ARM version takes 4.5 minutes (this is with a Winchester)). It should be even faster again when running on an Archimedes.

No, under no circumstances does it do anything nasty like writing directly to memory at fixed addresses (eg. the screen). I think I got all the nasty little things like this out when I first ran it on a 6502 second processor and over a network.

I was in the habit of charging £5 to supply the program on your own discs (it always seems safer to format the discs on the target machine). However, since the documentation is not up to date for the ARM BASIC version, you can have it free if you send me a disc. The program comes in a source form suitable for Twin, as well as the tokenised BASIC program, plus a small utility for taking out the comments.

I have unfortunately not tested the program on an Archimedes machine, since the only one I had access to wouldn't talk to the network where my cave survey files lived ! I can see no reason why it shouldn't work on an Archimedes, however, as I don't do anything that is dependent on Brazil (the ARM co-processor kernel) that wouldn't work on Arthur. (There are deficiencies in Brazil, which I avoid, but anyway, these are all supposed to

Swinton Castle
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4/4/88

Andy Waddington

Dear Andy,

Thanks for your epic letter recieved March 88. I also apologise for the delay in replying, not so much wintery sports as in your case but more 'slogging me guts out'. But enough of excuses.

Thanks very much for the offer of SUBBC for free, however, you have put alot of work into producing this masterpiece of software wizardry (d'ya like it) and I feel that it's only fair that you should get something for it. Please accept the cheque enclosed as a gift for your kindness.

Thanks also for the information about computers in surveying. I see you came accross the same names as myself, thanks for David MacKenzie's address.

I was interested to see that you must have been working on the ARM processor for some time before the Arc was released, lucky you, I'll let you know the timings for my Arc when I have the prog up and running. Thanks also for allowing me to rewrite or adapt the graphics for my Arc, when I've done this I'll let you have the coding, it might be useful for someone.

It seems to me that I have said alot of thankyou's and that can only mean that you have been more than kind.

Please find enclosed an ADFS 640k formatted disk titled Cave Survey, a stamp and a return label.

Once again Thanks and I look forward to hearing from you.

God Bless You

A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read 'Steve Laugher', with a stylized flourish extending from the end.

Steve Laugher